

WORKSHOP PROPOSAL

Business Writing Essentials

A half-day workshop for teams that need their emails, reports and proposals to be read, decided on and acted upon.

Prepared for: Harbourview Consulting Group, Halifax, NS
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Summary

Harbourview's consulting team writes to clients every day, and the quality of that writing shapes how the firm is judged. This proposal sets out a half-day workshop for up to 16 consultants that teaches one repeatable structure for emails, reports and proposals, practised on the team's own documents. The investment is CAD 1,200 for the session, with a follow-up review four weeks later included.

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1. Overview

Most workplace writing fails for one of three reasons: the point arrives too late, the reader has to work too hard, or the next step is unclear. In a consulting firm those failures are expensive. Proposals are skimmed rather than read, recommendations are questioned because they were buried, and follow-up emails go unanswered because nobody could see what was being asked.

Business Writing Essentials is a practical half-day session built around a single structure that fixes all three problems. Participants do not sit through a lecture on grammar. They bring real documents, rewrite them in the room and leave with something they can send the same afternoon.

The programme was developed over twelve years of teaching business communication at university level and has been delivered to teams in professional services, education and the public sector.

2. Objectives

By the end of the workshop every participant will be able to:

1. Open any email, report or proposal with the decision or request the reader needs to see first.
2. Cut a draft by a third without losing meaning, using a five-point editing checklist.
3. Close every document with a clear next step, owner and date.
4. Review a colleague's draft in under five minutes using a shared standard.

3. Programme

3.1 Format

The session runs for three and a half hours, online or on-site at Harbourview's Halifax office. It combines short demonstrations with timed rewriting exercises, and every exercise uses documents the participants bring with them. A pre-workshop survey and a one-page preparation note are sent one week before the session.

3.2 Agenda

Time	Module	What participants practise
9:00	Start with the point	Rewriting real emails so the decision or request comes first
10:00	Write for the reader	Cutting jargon, shortening sentences, using headings and lists
11:00	Make the next step obvious	Clear calls to action, deadlines and ownership
12:00	Apply it	Each participant rewrites one document from their own

Time	Module	What participants practise
		inbox and receives feedback

3.3 What participants leave with

- A three-part structure that works for any email, report or proposal.
- A one-page editing checklist for the team's shared drive.
- One real document rewritten, reviewed and ready to send.
- A follow-up review of three further documents, four weeks after the session.

4. Investment and logistics

Item	Detail
Duration	3.5 hours, including one 15-minute break
Format	Online (Microsoft Teams or Zoom) or on-site in Halifax
Group size	6 to 16 participants
Investment	CAD 1,200 per session, plus travel at cost for on-site delivery outside Toronto
Includes	Pre-workshop survey, participant workbook, editing checklist, four-week follow-up review
Proposed dates	Tuesday 4 November or Thursday 13 November 2026, 9:00 to 12:30 Atlantic time

Payment is due within 30 days of the session. Dates can be rescheduled once without charge with ten working days' notice.

5. About the facilitator

Dr. Elena Marsh teaches business communication at university level and founded Northlight Learning Studio to bring the same clarity to working professionals. She has taught more than 3,000 students and professionals and delivered over 40 workshops to teams.

- PhD, Communication Studies
- MA, Applied Linguistics
- Certified Adult Educator

6. Next steps

1. Confirm a preferred date from the two options in section 4.
2. Nominate up to 16 participants; we send the pre-workshop survey within two working days.
3. Participants each choose one document to bring to the session.

We would be glad to discuss any adjustments to the programme. Please reply to this proposal or book a 20-minute call at northlightlearning.example.

Dr. Elena Marsh

Founder, Northlight Learning Studio

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Design sample. Northlight Learning Studio, Harbourview Consulting Group and the people named are fictional, created for portfolio purposes.